The AI Interview Protocol

How Vista Growth can turn its $7,500 audit into a self-service qualification engine — and why Jackie can build it in 8 weeks

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THE PROBLEM

Scaling Your Best Product

The AI Transformation Audit is Vista Growth's entry product — $7,500, delivered over 2 weeks. Current state assessment, AI Opportunity Matrix, ROI projections, 90-day action plan.

It's good work. But it requires Steve or Jackie in a room for every engagement. That's a bottleneck, not a business.

What if prospects could experience a taste of the audit before they buy — and Vista Growth got qualified leads while they sleep?

CURRENT MODEL

- Manual discovery calls
- 1 client at a time
- No pre-qualification
- Prospects learn nothing until they pay

THE OPPORTUNITY

AI Interviews Outperform Everything

Conversational AI interviews are a new category. Not chatbots. Not forms. Not surveys. They're **adaptive, voice-based conversations** that probe, follow up, and summarize — and the data on them is striking.

95%
COMPLETION
Audio AI interviews

10-30%
COMPLETION
Traditional web forms

5x
RICHER DATA
With AI probing follow-ups

78%
PREFER AI
Over human interviewers

Anthropic's own study: 1,250 AI interviews — **97.6% satisfaction**, 99% would recommend. Participants valued the AI's ability to summarize and reflect back what they said.

WHY AUDIO

Skip Video. Go Voice-Only.

The research is clear: audio-only beats video on every metric that matters. No camera anxiety, no lighting hassles, no avatar uncanny valley. Just a conversation.

People are more honest when they're not being watched. No micro-reactions trigger response filtering. No demographic matching concerns. The absence of visual judgment signals is the feature.

95% COMPLETION | VIDEO: 40-60% | 10-20X CHEAPER

WHAT MAKES AI INTERVIEWS WORK

- AI summarizes and reflects back
- Adaptive follow-ups based on answers
- Transparent about AI nature (builds trust)
- No judgment signals — greater candor
- Pause, reflect, resume on own schedule

THE PRODUCT

The Vista Growth AI Readiness Interview

A 15-minute audio conversation at **audit.vistagrowth.ai**. The prospect talks. The AI listens, probes, and scores. Vista Growth gets a qualified lead with structured data before anyone picks up the phone.

WHAT THE PROSPECT GETS

15-min adaptive conversation covering their marketing ops, tech stack, team size, AI usage, and pain points

AI-scored ***"transformation readiness"*** across multiple dimensions

Personalized PDF report with Vista Growth branding

Clear CTA to book the full $7,500 engagement

WHAT VISTA GROWTH GETS

Full transcript + AI-generated summary in Airtable

Qualification score — **know who's worth a call** before calling

Structured data on pain points, budget signals, urgency

Prospects pre-sold on Vista Growth's expertise through the experience itself

The interview IS the sales tool. Prospects experience firsthand what **well-designed AI interaction** feels like — which is exactly what Vista Growth promises to deliver.

ARCHITECTURE

How It Works

Prospect Arrives
audit.vistagrowth.ai

›

AI Interview
15 min, adaptive

›

Score + Report
PDF emailed to prospect

›

Airtable CRM
Transcript + scores

›

Steve Calls
Pre-qualified lead

COST PER INTERVIEW

$2-5 per 15-minute interview using voice AI APIs like Retell.ai or Vapi.ai (varies by LLM and voice quality). At 50 interviews/month, that's **$100-250** — less than one hour of consulting time.

CONVERSION MATH

50 interviews → 47 complete (95% rate) → ~10 qualified leads → 2-3 close at $7,500 = **$15,000-22,500** from ~$250 in AI costs.

BEYOND QUALIFICATION

Three Strategic Plays

The interview protocol isn't just a lead gen tool. It's a platform that opens three distinct revenue and credibility strategies for Vista Growth.

01

Lead Qualification — Light Version

A short, open interview for new prospects. They self-qualify, get a free report, and **experience AI-powered consulting firsthand**. This is the entry point — the door opener.

› Evolves into deeper post-signup interviews

02

Multi-Stakeholder Deep Dive

Post-signup, multiple people from the same org take **role-specific interviews** — CMO gets strategy questions, ops gets workflow questions. The system generates an organizational rollup — where leaders agree, where they diverge. That divergence is a consultable finding itself.

03

White-Label for Clients

Once the protocol works for Vista Growth, **license the framework to clients.** Their own branded AI interviews for customer research, employee surveys, market assessments. New revenue stream from the same architecture.

PLATFORM OPTIONS

Buy a Platform or Build Your Own

Two real options. Each has trade-offs.

BUY — Use an Existing Platform

Platforms like **TheySaid** ($49-149/mo, free tier) or **Ribbon AI** ($499-999/mo) offer conversational AI interviews out of the box — adaptive questioning, built-in analysis, reporting.

- Fast to launch — days, not weeks
- Good for validating the concept
- Limited branding and customization
- No multi-stakeholder rollups

$49-999/MO | DAYS TO LAUNCH

BUILD — Jackie Builds It with Retell.ai

Same boilerplate as PolyWiz. **Retell.ai** or **Vapi.ai** handle the voice AI (~$2-5 per interview depending on configuration). Jackie builds the branded UI, scoring engine, PDF reports, and multi-stakeholder rollups.

- White-labeled at audit.vistagrowth.ai
- Full control — branding, scoring, rollups
- **Proves Vista Growth builds AI tools**
- 4-6 weeks development time

~$2-5/INTERVIEW | ~$150-300/MO

THE BUILD

8-Week Timeline

WEEKS 1-2 Design + Validate

Design the interview flow — 15-20 questions across marketing ops, tech stack, team structure, AI readiness

Deploy on TheySaid (free tier)

Run 10-20 test interviews with friendly contacts. Iterate on question flow and scoring.

WEEKS 3-4 Production + Integration

Move to Ribbon AI for real-time voice conversations

Connect to Airtable — transcripts, scores, lead qualification

Design the branded PDF report template. Set up email delivery with CTA.

WEEKS 5-6 Custom Build

Jackie clones the boilerplate, integrates Retell.ai voice API

White-labeled at audit.vistagrowth.ai — full brand control

Multi-stakeholder support: independent interviews per participant, organizational rollup view.

WEEKS 7-8 Launch + Optimize

Go live with real prospects. Monitor completion rates and qualification accuracy.

Tune scoring model based on which leads actually convert to audits

Begin pitching multi-stakeholder assessments as a premium upsell.

JACKIE'S BUILD

Same Boilerplate. Different Product.

The same Next.js + Supabase boilerplate that powered PolyWiz gives Jackie a running start. Authentication, database, dashboard, API routes — all solved. She focuses on the interview logic, the scoring model, and the report generation.

The voice AI is an API call. Retell.ai handles speech-to-text, the conversational AI, and the transcript. Jackie's app handles everything around it — the branded UI, the scoring, the PDF, the CRM flow.

NEXT.JS | SUPABASE | RETELL.AI | CLAUDE CODE

WHAT JACKIE BUILDS

- Landing page + interview embed
- Scoring engine (AI-scored dimensions)
- PDF report generator
- Admin dashboard for Steve
- Multi-stakeholder rollup view

THE NUMBERS

Buy vs. Build

BUY — USE A PLATFORM

Ribbon AI (real-time voice)	**$499-999/mo**
TheySaid (text-based, simpler)	**$49-149/mo**
Year 1 cost	**$1,800-12,000**

Fast to start. Limited branding and customization. No multi-stakeholder rollup. You're renting someone else's infrastructure.

BUILD — OWN IT

Voice AI API (~50 interviews/mo @ $2-5 each)	**~$100-250/mo**
Vercel + Supabase + email	**~$50/mo**
Year 1 cost	**~$2,000-3,600**

Jackie builds it with the boilerplate + Claude Code. Full brand control. Multi-stakeholder rollups. White-labeled at audit.vistagrowth.ai. And it proves Vista Growth's AI capabilities to every prospect who uses it.

Either path: 1 closed audit ($7,500) covers a full year of operating costs. The build path costs the same to run — and doubles as a showcase of what Vista Growth can do with AI.

The Interview Is the Product

Prospects don't read whitepapers. They don't sit through webinars. But they'll spend 15 minutes talking about their own problems — and walk away impressed that Vista Growth built the tool that listened.

TIMELINE	RUNNING COST	BREAK-EVEN
8 weeks to launch	~$150-300/mo	1 closed audit